

The mines were programmed to deactivate after a certain period of time. Thus the channel had to be "re-seeded" periodically. By early 1973, US forces had deposited 11,603 mines in North Vietnamese ports and waterways at a total cost of \$9.5 million.

The success of the US mining operation is extremely difficult to judge. The CIA had repeatedly warned that the North Vietnamese army requirements for war in the South were so small that stopping entry into Haiphong would not affect their supplies. Although the NVA's move to conventional warfare in the Easter Offensive had greatly increased its logistics requirements, and that offensive died down after May 1972, it is not clear if the cessation was a result of the mining operation. The most intense phase of the offensive had halted before the mining of the harbor began.